

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 18

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

KF Confession 4 reminds us of how we waste our energy in the service of the Idol. Let's hear it again:

We judged ourselves and others with contempt and felt justified in our wrath.

In the Gospel of Matthew, chapter 5, Jesus helps us think through what we really want. We can stop wasting our energy thinking, "I should do that," and, instead, use our energy to ask, "What outcome do I want, and how do I get it?"

Jesus taught us to be motivated by our wants and not by the law of our shoulds. Our text for this lesson is **Matthew 5:3–10** and we will be reading this well-known passage in Nancy's translation.

³Happy are beggars in spirit who are continually pleading and crying out for spiritual connection, because the kingdom of heaven is theirs.

⁴Happy are those who truly mourn, because they are the ones who shall be comforted by someone who is called alongside to help.

⁵Happy are the mild and gentle, for they shall inherit the earth.

⁶Happy are those who hunger and thirst for orientation, because they are the ones that shall be satisfied like grazing herds in a spring meadow.

⁷Happy are the compassionate and merciful, for they are the ones who shall receive help, compassion, and mercy.

⁸Happy are the single-minded, pruned, purified by fire, and free from their guilty, craving hearts, because they are the ones who shall see God.

⁹Happy are those who generate peace, for they shall be called the sons of God and carry His name.

¹⁰Happy are those who have been persecuted for the sake of orientation, for theirs is the kingdom of heaven.

Take a deep breath.

Jesus tells us how to be happy, blessed, and favored. He also exposes the lies that we tell ourselves about what we believe would make us happy. He invites us to build a happy life by developing oriented qualities and choosing oriented behaviors. Unfortunately, oriented behaviors are difficult to learn when we are caught in the grip of the Idol's pride system—and it is much easier to claim to possess Christian qualities than it is to grow them in our lives.

Jesus says that if we want to know real, abiding happiness and experience the karis favor of God, we must recognize the poverty of our Idol's pride system and choose another poverty—we must become beggars in the spirit. Beggars learn quickly what works and what doesn't work. They are highly motivated to get their needs met and do not waste energy gratifying pride. No beggar comes to a time when he can stop begging. The hunger and thirst that he feels today he will feel tomorrow. The beggar keeps begging until he dies. In KF, we learn to keep begging every day for the needs of our soul to be provided and for an ever-expanding spiritual connection with God—and we will need to keep begging as long as we are training here in this material world.

Look at the list of beatitudes in Matthew 5. Each line begins with "Happy." Do you want to be happy, or favored? Perhaps you have a claim that you deserve happiness because you have certain beliefs. You might envy the apparent happiness of others and yet ignore the ways in which you are making yourself unhappy. Do you know that it is within your power to be happy, favored, and blessed? Look at the causes of happiness at the end of the sentences in our text. We are happy because we have spiritual authority, because we will be comforted, because we will be satisfied, because we will see God. In order to produce the causes that have the effect of making you happy, Jesus says that you must develop certain qualities and make certain choices. The unwillingness to develop these qualities and make these choices is what interferes with your happiness.

What do you really want?

Trying to motivate yourself by what you think you should do will not help you. You need to learn to start motivating yourself by what you want. Rather than thinking, "I should hunger and thirst for spiritual connection," you might realize that what you really want is to be satisfied. On the other hand, you might claim that you do hunger and thirst for spiritual connection, or orientation, but your lack of satisfaction is evidence that your claim has no substance. How do you become satisfied? Jesus tells you how. Learn to keep asking, seeking, and knocking for orientation, just as a hungry person asks, seeks, and knocks for food, and you will be satisfied.

We might compare the motivation of shoulds with the motivation of real wanting. Listen to the following statements and use your mindfulness training to observe your emotional reactions:

- I should be a beggar in the spirit.
- I should hunger and thirst for orientation.
- I should be gentle.
- I should be a peacemaker.

How does that feel? (*Pause for 5 seconds*)

Now, notice how you feel when you hear the following statements:

- I want spiritual authority.
- I want to be satisfied and fulfilled.
- I want to inherit the earth.
- I want peace within and around me.

Does this second list of statements feel less tense, more single-minded, and more congruent—more like the voice of your True Self? Does your body feel less strain? *(Pause for 5 seconds)*

So, what is the problem that prevents your progress toward God's provision of happiness? This might seem a little crazy, but there are days and even years when we do not want to have spiritual authority, receive mercy, be at peace, or be satisfied. The problem is that a big part of us does not want to be well. Our pride stands in the way. But the good news is that we can allow ourselves to be messed up in our feelings and still choose life. No matter what you feel, choose life. As you taste real life and its outcomes, you will learn how worthwhile it is to keep working toward achieving it.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Lord, I am willing to be happy. Show me how to get there. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator,

We are grateful for this time together to heal and to train. Hold us in the power of this redirected energy as You guide us to our real glory. Show us the next step in our healing this week. We want to co-labor with You so that we can access all of Your karis gifts in this life and the next, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath